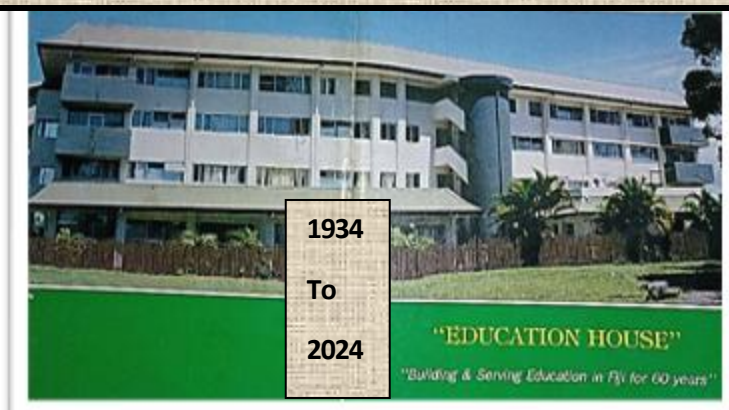


HISTORY OF THE FIJIAN TEACHERS ASSOCIATION -SOME HIGHLIGHTS

“Service Before Self”



THE BIRTH OF FTA: This took place in 1934 when it was first called, the Fijian Native Teachers Association (FNTA). This was officially established at Natabua with only 20 members at the original site of the Natabua Primary School at the periphery of Lautoka Town.

SIGNIFICANT EVENTS THAT FOLLOWED

1948- FNTA was renamed, Fijian Teachers Association (FTA).

1958- Conference on ‘Teachers’ Pension and Pre-Service Training’ by FTA and FTU with the then Colonial Secretary.

1959-FTA made a submission to the Burns Commission. Sir Allan Burns, a British civil servant, was tasked to table a report on the state of British colonialism to the UN. This was part of the UN’s mandate to review the status of people in colonies and those under UN Trusteeship. This was held at the then Legislative Council Chamber of Fiji.

1960- FTA celebrated its Silver Jubilee Celebrations at Albert Park with the Acting Governor, Mr. P.D. McDonald, as Chief Guest.

1961- FTA was registered as a Trade Union by the President, Livai Volavola.

1969- First Fiji Education Commission was held to which FTA made a submission.

1970- 4-12 August: 19th Assembly of the World Confederation of Organisations of the Teaching Profession, W.C.O.T.P., Sydney. Theme – ‘The Qualities of the Teacher’. NOTE: FTA became affiliated to the WCOTP which was a world body of Teachers’ professional organizations as well as Teachers’ unions. At that time, there were two world- bodies of teachers, namely, WCOTP and IFFTU-International Federation of Free Teachers Unions. FTA was represented by Emitai Boladuadua and Moses U. Velia both of whom were studying in Australia at the time.

- 1973 (a) FTA purchased Mrs Ryder’s property at 68 Knolly Street at \$42,000;
(b) FTA negotiated with success better conditions for teachers at the Job Evaluation conducted that year.
(c) FTA Credit Union was established.

1974 The FTA Welfare Scheme was established to address the social welfare needs of its members.

- 1976 First organized Pacific Regional Seminar was held at the Nasinu Teachers College jointly organized by WCOTP, FTA and FTU.
- (a) 1977 Arbitration on Teachers' working conditions where FTA was represented by Joeli Kalou assisted by O'Connor of the Australian Teachers Federation.
- (b) First FTA attendance of WCOTP Conference by an FTA President as a new member. Held in Nigeria. Reps.: Mrs Kamikamica, President and Ratu Semi Seruvakula, Vice President.
- 1978 (a) **Ratu Sukuna Foundation Fund launched** at Ratu Sukuna Park by Ratu Penaia Ganilau.
- (b) FTA participated in overseas world convened Teachers' conferences and workshops: -
- WCOTP – Jarkarta by Joeli Kalou as VPA and Taufu Vakatale;
 - IFFTU Seminar –Manila, Asivorosi Rakanace;
 - WCOTP Regional Conference-Port Moresby, Tevita Galuvakadua and Melisitima Digitaki;
 - WCOTP Regional Conference-Isimeli Cokanasiga as General Secretary and Mere Gina Saroniceva of Tailevu South Branch.
- 1979 (a) Laying of Foundation Stone for Education House at 68 Knolly Street during the FTA AGM by Ratu Sir George Kadavulevu Cakobau.
- (b) Official Opening of Education House in December by the Prime Minister of Fiji, Ratu Kamisese Mara.
- 1981 (a) First Pacific Regional Teachers Organization was established in Wellington, New Zealand as Council of Pacific Teachers Organization (CPTO) and of which FTA was a founding member. Ilai Kuli represented FTA.
- (c) FTA negotiated the facilitation of Joeli Nabuka's release from government to take up a Research Fellowship role at the Institute of Education, USP with the assistance of the FTA Ratu Sukuna Foundation Fund. This was to research into the existing gap between the low academic achievements of indigenous Fijian secondary school students as shown in their external examination results; and those of non-indigenous students'.
- 1982 A historic milestone was reached when FTA and FTU decided to form the **Fijian Teachers Confederation** at the Nasinu Teachers College. This was to allow the two unions to jointly negotiate for teachers' working conditions. This came after calls by government to have only one teachers' union.
- 1983 **FTA affiliated to Fiji Trades Union Congress when Joeli Kalou Sovaki was President.**
- 1984 (a) Golden Jubilee of FTA celebrated at the AGM held at Natabua High School, Lautoka.
- (b) Judicial Review of Nicol & Hurst Award as applied by FTC.
- (c) FTA's public demonstration through a march against The Teachers Volunteer Scheme which saw young school leavers and under-graduates of USP being made to first serve as volunteer teachers before employment. That was, to join the teaching cadre of Fiji without any required teacher training and with no pay; except for

a small allowance. FTA with FTU objected on professional grounds. Their position was that education should not be delivered in the classrooms by non- professionally trained teachers. That undermined the value, worth and standards of the teaching profession as well as the quality of education in Fiji.

(d) Overseas Conferences were attended by FTA representatives as follows:

- Joint WCOTP & CPTO Meeting in Rarotonga by Mrs Esiteri Kamikamica and Asivorosi Rakanace (In Their roles as President & General Secretary);
- Conference on “Cognition” –Melisitima Digitaki led a team of three;
- Lome Convention-Viliame Saulekaleka as President of FTA.

1985 (a) **A historic milestone was reached when FTA employed its first paid General Secretary, Joeli Kalou.** Previous to this, all FTA General Secretaries were elected by delegates at the Annual General Meetings.

NOTE: Joeli Kalou subsequently successfully ran for Parliament under the Labour Government where he became the Minister for Education in 1999 under the Prime Ministership of Mahendra Chaudary.

(b) FTA was represented in the following important overseas conferences & workshops: -

- Australian Teachers Federation (ATF) Conference in Tasmania by James Campbell;
- Asia/Pacific Regional Symposium of Supervisors of Schools in Vila, Vanuatu, by Remesio Rogovakalali.

(c) **Historic first ever strike by Teachers of Fiji(FTU/FTA)** to express opposition against the Teachers Volunteer Scheme imposed by the Minister for Education of the Alliance Party, Dr. Ahmed Ali. Took two weeks. In the arbitration that ensued, the Permanent Government Arbitrator, Professor John Young, ruled against the Volunteer Scheme declaring it ‘null and void’. Scheme hence abolished.

(d) FTA’s Ratu Sukuna Foundation Fund assisted in indigenous teachers acquiring their Masters Degrees at overseas universities: -

- i/ Joeli Nabuka- M.A (Ed), Macquarie University, Australia;
- ii/ Emasi Qovu - M.Ed.,University of New England, Australia;
- iii/ Paula Ralulu- M.A -University of Wollongong,Australia;
- iv/ Paula Kunabuli-M.Ed.,University of British Columbia,Canada.

(e) FTA employed for the first time a Research, Publicity and Election Officer. First appointee- Neori Cama an FTA member. This was to be followed by Master Tagica and later Master Valekuta, who died while holding office.

1986 FTA was represented at the World Congress of the Teaching Profession (WCOTP) held in Canada by President, V.Saulekaleka and Vice President Administration, Jiuta Volatabu. while Manasa Moce, FTA Treasurer, attended the ATF Conference in Australia.

July 1st -27th – Colombo Plan Staff College, Singapore – James Campbell

August 7th-13th – 10th World Confederation of Teaching Profession, Asia & Pacific Region Conference, Seoul – Alisi Wightman

- 1987 FTA closed office on 14th May and for several weeks thereafter because of the first military coup-de-tat in Fiji by Major Sitiveni Rabuka. This overthrew the Dr. Timoci Bavadra government and resulted in the 20% reduction of Civil Servants' salaries and devaluation of the Fiji dollar.
- 1988 FTA AGM at the then Fiji Institute of Technology, accepted the application for the establishment of an **FTA Branch for retired teachers called, RFTA.**
- 1990 (a) Council of Pacific Teachers Organization was held in Fiji. It established its first Women's Network and elected Susana Tuisawau Vice President Professional, as its first Chairperson. This was followed by the **establishment of FTA's own Women's Network.**
NOTE: There was no allocated budget nor time given in the AGM's official program for the Women's Network' meeting in those years. Hence women met at lunch breaks. Allocation in the FTA's Annual Budget and timetabling of the Women's Network Meeting during the FTA AGM came later under the Presidency of Tevita Koroi.
 Launching of the "Alisi Fusi Wightman's Scholarship" By CPTO (Now COPE) in honour of FTA's former Vice President, Alisi Fusi Wightman who passed away in Tonga in 1998 after relocating there with her husband.
 This Scholarship was to support two women teachers of Pacific Island COPE affiliates to take a week-long study trip on unionism in Australia or/and New Zealand.
- 1991 Ana Wightman attended the Clyde Cameron College which was the only residential college for Trade Union Training in Australia opened in 1976 under TUTA (Trade Union Training Authority).
- 1993 (a) **Another milestone in FTA's History was achieved when FTA and its two arms, the FTA Welfare Scheme and FTA Credit Union, each contributed \$60,000 towards the purchase of the adjacent property to FTA, 58 Knolly Street.** This was initially planned to house FTA's income generating activities under the then called, SNQ or Soqosoqo Ni Qasenivuli (I Taukei).
- (b) Signing of the **Amalgamation Agreement of WCOTP and IFFTU in January** in Europe to form **Education International with Mary Futrell of USA as first President.** Jiuta Volatabu represented and signed in FTA as one of the first registered organizations of EI.
- (c) **Historic Job Evaluation Exercise by Deloitte & Thomson** who was commissioned to review the Public Service. FTA & FTU with the support of the Ministry of Education, won their negotiation to have a separate TOR for the review of the Education Sector. This was to correct the folly of the previous Nicol & Hurst Job Evaluation where all civil service workers were evaluated by one common TOR.
 Hence for the first time the following issues were included in the TOR: Class size; Allowances or Incentives for Rural/Remote Service; Heads of Department; Executive Teachers Posts; multiple classes teaching; Special Education; Schools Classifications and Grading; Teachers responsibilities and skills; Merit increments. Outcome of the Job Evaluation saw the passing of almost all of what FTC had negotiated.

- 1994 (a) Sad passing of the FTA President, Jiuta Volatabu while holding Office for only about eight months. Susana Tuisawau, the VPA, took over as President and was subsequently elected into the position at the following elections.
- (b) Death of FTA's General Secretary, Eroni Biukoto, also while in office.
- (c) FTA Diamond Jubilee Celebrations (60 years). This was marked by: -
- Launching of a FTA Diamond Jubilee Professional Journal;
 - Reforming of FTA Choir and Launching of the first FTA Choir Record with the label, "Album of Old Fijian Classics". The songs sung were composed by a retired FTA Member, Eremasi Tamanisau Senior;
 - Sale of FTA memorabilia for the first time. These being FTA Ties, cuff-links, blazers and scarves;
 - A Symposium on Educational Issues was held at the Civic Center.
 - March through Suva City by Decades.
 - Launching of FTA's Song, "We Have Come A Long Way".
- 1995 (a) **Historic demonstration march of the Fiji Trades Union Congress from Albert Park to the French Embassy at the Dominion House which FTUC assigned FTA to lead.** This was to show objections to the testing of Nuclear Bombs by France in the Pacific at the Mururoa Atolls, Tahiti. Twelve long coconut baskets of signed petitions were presented.
- The Minister for Education, Science & Technology at the time, Taufu Vakatale, joined this march and this resulted in her removal as Minister for Education by the Prime Minister, Sitiveni Rabuka.
- (b) **The historic first Education International Congress** was convened in Harare, Zimbabwe, Africa, by the country's President, Mugabe, a former Teacher. This saw the merged body of the two largest Teachers world bodies, WOCTP (World Organization of the Confederation of Teaching Professionals) and IFFTU (International Federation of Free Teachers Unions) into Education International meeting as one in its first global conference. Susana Tuisawau represented FTA. A significant role was played by FTA as she presented the motion from the Pacific EI affiliates, seeking EI support regarding the French Nuclear Testing in the Pacific. The fight was then taken up by the French Teachers' unions in Paris and other unions and civil society organizations which contributed significantly to the cessation of nuclear testing in the Pacific.
- 1996 (a) **Two historic FTA milestones were reached when the FTA AGM passed two significant resolutions: -**
- i/ **To deduct \$5 from each member's fortnightly contribution of FTA membership fees of \$12.** This was to go towards a FTA Housing Scheme which was to be launched in 2000 after \$2.4 million had been collected.
- NOTE: This materialized as planned in 2000 when members were allowed to utilize funds from the Housing Scheme for land leases or as down payments for leases or for house repairs & renovations.*
- ii/ **To adopt FTA official colours. These being Gold and Maroon.** Neumi Vola, the Area Rep. for Beqa, Yanuca and Namosi, was assigned by the FTA National Executive to table and explain the rationale for this choice to the AGM.

- (b) FTA President was elected as Vice President of Fiji Trades Union Congress and this was followed by her election to the world body of trade union 's Women's Executive Committee of ITUC (International Trade Union Confederation).
- 1997 (a) FTA fully paid for the FNPF loan of \$2.5 million for the FTA Education House.
- (b) FTA made a submission to the Reeves Constitutional Review Commission led by FTA President. Most of what FTA had asked for in its submission regarding unions, appeared in the 1997 Constitution.
- (c) July 24th -26th: Education International Regional conference, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia – attended by President Susana Tuisawau, Lepani Kolinisau (Asst. GS), Mikaele Ruru (Lautoka Rep)
- 1998 First time in history for the FTA to have a big delegation consisting of eight FTA members to attend the Second Education International's World Congress in Washington DC. The EI Congress was opened by President Clinton.
- 1999 (a) FTA made a submission to Fiji's Education Commission instituted by the ruling Fiji Labour Government. The Commission was under the responsibility of the then Minister for Education, Pratap Chand, the former FTU/FTC General Secretary. Sectors covered included: (i) Pre School Education (ii) Primary Education (iii) Secondary Education (iv) Special Education (v) Teacher Training & Higher Education (vi) Education for the Indigenous People (vii) Community Adult Education (viii) Technical & Vocational Education (ix) Assessment Methods
- (b) Year reached the highest level of membership with 3,800 paying members. Further, year uniquely noted for the beginning of week-long AGMs that followed in subsequent years in the same pattern which involved meetings during the day inclusive of a President's Night, An Annual Fund-raising Concert, An Annual Bazaar, Annual Sports Competition and the AGMs of all other arms of FTA e.g. Credit Union and FTA Welfare etc. March 25 –
- (c) May 23rd-29th – Education International 3rd Asia Pacific Regional Conference, New Delhi, India. Attended by President Susana Tuisawau and Asinate Gadolo
- (d) For the first time FTA & FTU were invited by the Ministry for Education to jointly select teachers for In-Service Training Scholarship.
- 2000(a) The business arm of the FTA was registered with the Registrar of Companies as SNQ (Soqosoqo ni Qasenivuli I Taukei). It later became known as the FTA Holdings. The 65th AGM raised a total sum of \$12,013 during the bazaar at 11 Knollys Street Park. Participation: GS Maika Namudu, Turin, Italy, ILO and Workers Rights with Distant Learning Preparations; Mr. Tevita Koroi (VPA) Israel: The role of the Labour Movement in National Developments.
- (b) Coup-de-tat by George Speight removed Labour Government. Schools were closed.
- * Another milestone for FTA reached by its conducting of classes for the first time at the premises to cater for students sitting external examinations at Secondary and Primary Schools. Organizer was Remesio Rogovakalai assisted by Ravesi Johnston.**

- (c) FTA President and Secretary were appointed by government into various national bodies e.g. National OHS Board; Labour Advisory Board; FIT Council; FNTC Council; Trade Union Council.

2001(a) FTA President left to take up position as Secretary General of Council of Pacific Education (COPE) and Tevita Koroi took office as elected FTA President.

- (b) FTA and FTU jointly held 'Peace & Reconciliation' Workshops with EI funding to address the mounting racial tension and conflicts that took place in the aftermath of Speight's coup.

- (c) The FTA President and General Secretary were chosen as Tripartite Committee members by Government on the following national decision-making fora: -

National OHS Board	- President
Labour Advisory Board	- President
FIT Council	- General Secretary
FNTC Council	- General Secretary
Trade Union Advisory Council	- General Secretary
FNTC/Finance & Resource Com.	- General Secretary

2002(a) FTA Housing Scheme of \$2.4 million matured and opened to members in April. (NOTE: *From the result of saving \$5 per member every fortnight for 4 full years since 1997 after the FTA loan for Education House was fully paid*)

- (b) President Tevita Koroi, Tokasa Vitayaki, Chair, Women's Network and Viniana Kunabuli, attended the 3rd EI World Congress in Jomtien, Thailand.

2003(a) FICTU was formed by some national unions due to some differences within the FTUC leadership. FTA withdrew from FTUC and joined the newly formed FICTU (Fiji Islands Council of Trade Unions). The office of was located within FTA Education House. FICTU represented workers from FTA, Public Employees Union and Viti National Trade Union. FICTU was not recognized by ILO and FTUC remained the only ILO recognized national umbrella union body with the most membership of workers' unions.

**NOTE: FTA later rejoined FTUC.*

- (b) FTA represented at the EI Asia-Pacific Regional Conference at Taipei, Taiwan by President, Tevita Koroi.

2004 (a) FTA celebrated its 70th Anniversary. Negotiations for a cost of living adjustment resulted in a 2% COLA payment across all civil servants' base salaries.

- (b) The FTA Welfare leading officers unilaterally made the decision to buy the property at Denison Road and moved its office there. The ensuing controversy with the FTA National Executive Board resulted in certain concerned members taking legal action against FTA National Executive Board. However, the FTA National Executives won the case.

- (c) Education International Congress in Brazil opened by the President of the country, a Former National Trade Union Secretary General of Brazil. President Tevita Koroi led the FTA delegation.

2005 (a) FTA President, Tevita Koroi, was elected by Fiji Federation of Non-State Actors (FONSA) to be its first President.

- (b) A first for FTA when its General Secretary, Maika Namudu represented FTUC as a worker's representative at the 93rd ILO Conference, Geneva, Switzerland

**Total number of FTA members – 4169.*

2006 (a) Signing of the Partnership Agreement between Government and the Public Sector Unions on the Industrial Relations Framework. This Agreement was made on the following issues: -

- i. Absorption of Grant-In-Aid Teachers into the Civil Service;
- ii. Increase in Teachers Scholarship;
- iii. Implementation of the Permanent Arbitrators Award of 2005;
- iv. Performance Management System;
- v. Increase in the Teaching Establishment (i.e. to increase the number of registered posts in the teaching sector and maximum number of non-post holders that can be employed in the Ministry as Teachers);
- vi. Lowering of Pupil/Teacher Ratio;
- vii. A Job Evaluation Exercise.

OUTCOMES:

- **Payments of COLA; Merit Increments for the years 2005 & 2006;**
- **Lowering of MQR for HOD Technical & Vocational Programs**

(b) FTA Housing Assistance Scheme gave loan to 1,387 FTA members.

2007(a) Historic breakthrough with the absorption of 1,351 Grant-In- Aid Teachers into the civil service.

(b) FTA & the three FICTU affiliates went on strike because of government's reduction by 5% of civil service pay; reduction of retirement age to 55. First day of the strike was on Thursday, 02.08.07. On the afternoon of 2.8.2007, the Ministry announced its contingency plan to bring forward the school holidays by 2 weeks to Monday, 6.8.07, so that the strike would fall during the school holidays thus weakening FTC's cause. In response, FTA put up its counter contingency plan to call off the strike by Friday, 3.8.07, as it was pointless holding the strike during the school holidays.

(c) FTA took legal action against government for reducing teachers' holiday pay and won the

case. FTA's case was fought by Howards Lawyers. The interim government had imposed without any consultation (a) the Reduction of the Civil Services pay by 5%, (b.) reduction of the

Compulsory Retirement Age from 60 to 55 years (CRA);

(d) Shelving of the Partnership Agreement reached in 2006. FTA rejected (a), (b) and (c) above;

(e) Obtained a 75% strike mandate from members and fought against the above with FICTU affiliates (FTA/PEU/VNWTU) in a national strike in August.

** NOTE: FTU with FPSA did not participate in above strike. Fiji Nurses Association withdrew from FTUC and staged their own strike. A 'stay order' was sought in the High court for the government's decisions; but decisions were left in abeyance.*

** FTU Executives did not formally table an objection notification to government regarding the Compulsory Retirement Age of 55 years, leading to internal split amongst its members*

** Justice Decree passed prevented court challenges by unions.*

(f) EI Conference, Berlin, Germany. Attended by Tevita Koroi (President), Iosefo Volau (VP), Maika Namudu (GS), Miriama Namosimalua (Asst. Sec), Rusila Racule (PRO), Emasi Ravulo (Cakaudrove) Mrs. Mere Fisher (Principal – Savusavu Sec. Sch), Mrs. Ilisapeci Tawakeniqila (Principal, Yasawa Sec), Mrs. Piniana Seru (HT, Somosomo Dist. Sch), Miriama Nayato (HT, Rt. Naivalu Pr. Sch), Atelaite Tikonaivalu

- 2008 (a) FTA President, Tevita Koroi suspended for public statement against Interim Government during the FTA May AGM. Appeal to PSC Appeal Board made no decision.
 (b) NZ Education International donated \$14,150.53 to FTA for assistance.
 (c) 5% Salary cut restored.
- 2009 (a) PSC's appeal was successful in nullifying Justice F. Jitoko's December 2008 decision.
 NOTE: **The Appeal Court's ruling of the Qarase Vs Interim Regime case on 8th April resulted in the win by the Qarase Government as the rightful government of the people. Military instituted the 5th coup d'état on 9th April, 2009. Ratu Josefa Iloilo installed as President with Bainimarama as the Interim PM. Military Junta abrogated the Constitution and the Judiciary on 10/4/2009. This was to be the Order of the day for the next 5 years until 2014. FTA struggled to celebrate its 75th Anniversary AGM due to restrictions and imposition by the Military junta. FTA persisted in its request to have the AGM in May.*
- (b) The Institute of Indigenous Fijian Studies
 Was registered as an NGO on 18th September 2009 under the Companies Act. Its role and function is to (i) record and document indigenous Fijians' stories, history, cultural practices and expressions (ii) promote and preserve indigenous languages, culture and practices. (iii) protect the dignity and rights of indigenous communities to their traditional knowledge and intellectual property.
 Me da yadrava, taqomaka, ka vakabulabulataka na veika kece e da vakamareqeta na iTaukei.
- (c) FTA and unions of Fiji negatively affected by the abrogation of Fiji's 1997 Constitution by the military regime of Bainimarama. Interim PM ordered all striking teachers who joined the FTUC & NGOs public protest and strike at Nadi to have their holiday salaries deducted. FTA took legal action with Howards Lawyers. Salaries were restored by the Courts.
- 2010 (a) Conferences attended by FTA were: October 12-14: E.I. Asia/Pac Workshop, Geneva – T. Koroi ; Nov 17-19: E.I. Asia/Pac Meeting, Bangkok – T. Koroi ;30 Nov – 3 Dec: UN Sub-regional consultation on "The Operationalization of the UNDRIPS by national Human Rights Institutions", Auckland, NZ. – T. Koroi
 (b) Workshop of the Institute of Indigenous Studies – 15th to 16 November.
 The Institute organized a 2-day workshop on Indigenous Research. Opened by the President, Tevita Koroi. Dr Unaisi Nabobo Baba and Dr. Tupeni Baba were facilitators. The focus was on the Vanua Research Framework (VRF) which acknowledges and uses indigenous world views, philosophies, knowledge and processes/ protocols.
- 2011 (a) July: Education International's World Congress, Cape Town, South Africa – Mere Moci (President) and Miriama Namosimalua attended.
 (b) Tevita Koroi, the longest serving President (2001 - 2011) handed in his resignation letter and Mere Moci was his successor.
 (c) 2 September: Official Opening of the FTA's 21- Bedroom Na i Vakananumi Apartments (58 Knolly Street) by Ratu Epeli G Ganilau. Land was brought in 1993.
- 2012 (a) The Administration of Justice Decree of 2009 continued to prevent public sector unions and the general public from any legal challenge against the government. FTA members were therefore prevented from challenging non- payment arrears of 5% pay cut and the restoration of the retiring age of 60 as awarded by the court.

The Association appreciated the Public Order Amendment Decree that came into effect in 2012 which suspended Section 8 of the Public Order Act (Cap. 201). The Amendment decree allowed meetings to be held without having to apply for permits. However, public demonstrations were still not allowed.

Reduction in financial membership continued to be a concern after the cessation of the “check off” system by unions (direct deduction of FTA membership fees from a teacher’s salary). Please see table below;

FTA membership

YEAR	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013
MEMBERS	4045	4129	4269	4207	4222	4181	3928	3877	2707	2853

2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
									4200	

- (b) Education International Asia Pac Regional Committee meeting, Bangkok, Thailand-July 12th-18th.
- (c) Historical event when FTA responded to the government’s call for submission by the public to the Yash Ghai Constitutional Review Commission. An FTA team made its submission to the Commission at the Tamavua Primary School on 16th August. **13th October:** FTA handed in its second submission to the Constitution Commission at the GCC complex, Nasese.

NOTES ON THE 2013 CONSTITUTION of FIJI EXERCISE.

**22 December: copies of the draft Constitution seized and destroyed by Police. Some copies were shredded before being soaked in kerosene and burnt! *Subsequently on 10 Jan: At the 6.00pm FBC TV News bulletin, the President, Ratu Epeli Nailatikau, called the Yash Ghai draft Constitution, ‘very disappointing and an anathema to democratic representation and neglected many of the fundamental principles of true democratic representation.’ He then asked J.V. Bainimarama to institute moves to modify the Draft Constitution and align it with the “strongly supported” People’s Charter.*

**22 March: Interim Regime’s Draft Constitution out. Feedback from the people to be with the Solicitor General’s office by 5th April (2 weeks)*

12 April: Draft (2) Constitution out. Reaction to be with SG’s office by 30th April.

30 April: FTA response to the Interim Government’s Draft Committee handed in to Solicitor General’s Office.

** 6 September: 11am – Petition handed to President’s office opposition to Constitution.*

3.30pm – Assent of the 2013 Constitution by the President. The submission from the FTA and other parties was an exercise in futility as there was hardly any change made to the Draft Constitution to support/promote democratic principles and ideals.

** 14 women led by former FTA President, demonstrated with placards were arrested by Police beside the seawall at the front of Government House and detained for questioning. Released at 2.20pm with the intervention of the Lawyer Richard Naidu who had a team of lawyers volunteering to assist pro-bono.*

2016 Ratu Sukuna Memorial Lecture – 23 April

The Fiji First government had removed the celebration of the Ratu Sukuna Day in schools and the public at large. The FTA through the Institute of Indigenous Fijian Studies celebrated the life and legacy of Ratu Sir Lala Sukuna by organizing a Public Lecture on the

life of Ratu Sukuna on 23rd April 2016. This was held in the FTA Hall. The memorial lecture was delivered by Dr. Tupeni L. Baba. This was immediately followed by a panel of 5 speakers – Joji Kotobalavu, Hon. Professor Biman Prasad, Jope Tarai, Adi Finau Tabakaucoro and Lice Movono - Rova.

Long Island University (Global) – LIU(G) – New York

In September 2016, the CEO of the Institute of Indigenous Fijian Studies was a guest lecturer to a group of students from the Long Island University (Global) of New York. The Lecture was on Fiji's History and Political Development, and "Language, Culture and Tradition".

This has been an annual event since 2016.

- 2018 FTA Representatives delivered papers and played key roles in the first ever Conference in Pacific Philosophy, na Vuku ni Pasifika. **June 11 -14**. Hosted and sponsored by PTC, USP, FNU and the Pac. Islands Assoc. of NGOs. Over 300 participants from 12 Pacific countries, including NZ attended.

- 2019 Petition by FTA on **25 February** to the CEO of Suva City Council expressing its strong objection (with hundreds of signatures) to the planned rezoning of part of Thurston Gardens for the building of the Indian Chancery / High Commission.
 NOTE: 15 October: After the Director of Town and Country Planning approved the rezoning of part of the Thurston Gardens on 18th September, FTA lodged its appeal against this approval to the Minister for Local Government Housing and Community Development, copied to the Permanent Secretary for Local Government and the CEO of the Suva City Council. The building did not eventuate.

- 2020 **30th June**: The book "Na Veiwekani ni Vanua" by the late Ratu Semi B. Seruvakula former FTA General Secretary and former RFTA President, was launched by Mr. Fatiaki Misau, Chairman of the iTaukei Trust Fund Board. Mrs. Raijeli N. Seruvakula spoke for the Vanua of Nasautoka.

- 2021 Launching and blessing at FTA of ten iTaukei reading books for classes 1-3, written by seven (7) RFTA members by Rev. Aisea Rarokoliwa, former Principal of LMS in the FTA hall.

- 2022 Special Delegates Conference 13th October, 88th
 Theme – "Transformation of Education begins with Teachers".

- 2023 (a) FTA saw liberation of the unions from restrictions placed by the Fiji First government after the Fiji Alliance Party of Sitiveni Rabuka won the national elections and formed a Coalition Government with the Fiji Federation Party and Sodelpa Party.
 (b) Revival of Ratu Sukuna Day
 The Coalition government revived the celebration of the legacy of Fijian statesman, Ratu Sir Lala Sukuna. Ratu Sukuna Memorial lectures were held in the 3 universities: Professor Sitiveni Ratuva, University of Canterbury, NZ, delivered the Memorial lecture on 24th May; Mr. Emitai Boladua, member of the FTA was the chief guest at the Nasinu Campus of the FNU on 25th May and Joji Kotobalavu, Senior Lecturer in Law, University of Fiji was the Guest Speaker at the University of Fiji, Suva on 25th May.
 On Friday, 2nd May at the invitation of the Ministry of iTaukei Affairs, Mr. E. Boladua (FTA) attended a one-day symposium on "Leadership" and he spoke on the leadership and legacy of Ratu Sukuna.

In the evening, FTA organized a panel of speakers (Professor Unaisi Nabobo Baba, Peceli Rinakama, E. Boladuadua, Susana Tuisawau, Josefa Toganivalu, Deputy CEO of iTaukei Affairs) to speak on Ratu Sukuna's (i) education (ii) chiefly lineage – kawa vakaturaga (iii) sports achievement (iv) life story (v) achievements in iTaukei Affairs.

- (c) FTA made a written submission through the RFTA Branch, on the Review of the Great Council of Chiefs to the Review Committee appointed by Government.
- (d) FTA represented at the Education Forum convened by the Ministry of Education at Nadi, by the General Secretary in September.
- (f) FTA's Institute of Indigenous Studies (Lololo) continued to work in partnership with I Taukei Trust Fund Board on the writing and publishing of books in the I Taukei language. Further, Institute conducted classes in the I Taukei and Rotuman Languages to foreign students.

2024 (a) Education International's Conference in Argentina attended by the General Secretary, Paula Manumanunitoga and Nanise Kamikamica.

- (b) FTA's 90 Years Jubilee Anniversary Celebrations at the August Annual Delegates Conference.

Fig.1 PRESIDENTS FROM 1934 to 2024

NO.	YEARS	FTA PRESIDENTS	NO.	YEARS	FTA PRESIDENTS
1.	1934 – 1938	Joeli Ravai	14	1969 –1970	Sakiasi Sovanivalu
2.	1939 – 1942	Semesa Sikivou	15	1971 – 1973	Epeli Kacimaiwai
3.	1943 – 1945	Wilisoni Inia	16	1974 – 1976	Josevata Bolatakeu
4.	1946 – 1947	Isireli Racule	17	1977 – 1979	Esiteri Kamikamica
5.	1948	Adriu Naiyaga	18	1980 – 16/6/80	Jiofiliti Tadu
6.	1949 – 1950	Josua Rabukawaqa	19	1980 – 1984	Joeli Sovaki Kalou
7.	1951 – 1952	Semesa Sikivou	20	1985 – 1992	Viliame Saulekaleka
8.	1953 – 1954	Ratu Livai Volavola	21	1993 – Aug.1994	Jiuta Volatabu
9.	1955	Esala Kama	22	1994 – 2000	Susana S. Tuisawau
10.	1956 – 1957	Semesa Sikivou	23	2001 – 2011	Tevita Koroi
11.	1958 – 1962	Sakiasi Sovanivalu	24	2012 – 2015	Merewairita Moci
12.	1963 – 1964	Malakai Gucake	25	2015 - 2018	Gauna Halofaki
13.	1965 – 1968	Filipe Nagera Bole	26	2018 - 2025	Netani Druavesi

FIG 2 LIST OF SOME PAST FTA NATIONAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEES

(Note: Some years' lists are not available)

<u>1970,1971 Executive Committee</u> President: Sakeasi Sovanivalu Vice Presidents: Taufa V. Bole, Peni Q. Tukunia Gen. Secretary: Esiteri N. Kamikamica Assistant Sec. Maraia Nayacakalou Treasurer: Akisi N. Renner Grievances Officer: Sakiusa Yanuyanutawa Publicity Officer: Nemani Marama Committee Members: Tulia Koroi, Adi Davila Vunivalu, Navitalai Uluinaceva, Iliesa Nasedra, Vivita Devo, Amelia Loga, Emitai L. Boladuadua, Alena Cavu. Legal Advisor: Aminiasi Kato	<u>2001 Executive Committee</u> President: Tevita Koroi VP Admin.: Iosefo Volau VP Professional: Asinate Gadolo General Secretary: Maika Namudu Asst. G/Secretary: Peni Delaibatiki Treasurer: Josateki Malani Ind. Relations Officer: Lorima Voravora, Viniana Kunabuli, Amani Namosimalua, Mika Rokosova, A. Sokosoko, Toma Waqavono, S. Druguta, Viliame Dileqa, J. Cagilaba, Salesi Radrodoro, George V. Tabua, Nabunobuno, M. Ruru, Albert Wise, Jone Cawanibuka
<u>1985 Executive Committee</u> President: Viliame Tunidau VP (Ind. Relations.): Aminiasi Katonivualiku VP (Professional): Ilai Kuli (till Feb), Alisi D. Wightman (from March) General Secretary: Joeli Kalou Treasurer: Mosese Uluiciciya <u>Committee Members:</u> Asivorosi Rakanace, James Campbell, Apisai Daveta, Atunaisa Lacabuka, Susana Tuisawau, Eroni Biukoto, Remesio Rogovakalali, Tevita Waqabaca, Joji Uluinakauvadra, Nacanieli Ole Savu, Manasa Moce, Eremasi Rova (till Sept.), Meli Tokaibai (from Oct.)	<u>2002 Executive Committee</u> President: Tevita Koroi VP Admin.: Iosefo Volau General Secretary: Maika Namudu Asst. G/Secretary: Peni Delaibatiki Treasurer: Josateki Malani Public Relations Officer: Gauna Halofaki Lorima Voravora, Viniana Kunabuli, Amani Namosimalua, Eremasi Tamanisau, Mikaele Ruru, Salesi Radrodoro, Atunaisa Sokosoko, Iowane Bulivou, Seresio Druguta, Ieli Erasito, Albert Wise, Jone Cawanibuka, Tokasa Vitayaki, Josaia Cagilaba, Sitiveni Loco, Eci Naisele, Ropate Green
<u>1997 Executive Committee</u> President: Susana Tuisawau VP Admin: Joeli Nabuka VP Professional: Waisake Kedraika General Secretary: Maika Namudu Asst. G/Secretary: Lepani Kolinisau Publicity Officer: Mere Nawamea Treasurer: Paula Motu Asinate Gadolo, Tokasa Vitayaki, Meli Tokaibai, Rupeni Tamani, Peceli Vitukawalu, Sivaniolo Toroca, Kaminieli Tagica, Salaseini Fong, Aseri Tuitubou, Peceli Rinakama, Usaia Vakataga, Mikaele Ruru, Poasa Sausau, Iliesa Bose, Neumi Vola, S Waqanaceva, Apisalome Colanailagovesi, Viliame Dileqa, Suka Tigarea, Temo Tawake, Sitiveni Loco, Peni Delaibatiki, Albert Wise.	<u>2003 Executive Committee</u> President: Tevita Koroi VP Admin.: Iosefo Volau VP Professional: Tokasa Gray General Secretary: Asst. G/Secretary: Peni Delaibatiki Treasurer: Josateki Malani Public Relations Officer: Gauna Halofaki Rusila Racule, E. Ole, L. Kolinisau, Kelevi Bitu, Joji Nakaora, P. Vedewaqa, Amani Namosimalua, Eremasi Tamanisau, Taito Draunidalo, Atunaisa Sokosoko, Iowane Bulivou, Seresio Druguta, Josaia Cagilaba, Ropate, Green Vesikula, Jone. Malimali, Timoci Bure

LIST OF NATIONAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEES Cont.	LIST OF NATIONAL EXECUTIVE COMMITTEES Cont.
1998 <u>Executive Committee</u> President: Susana Tuisawau VP Professional: Tokasa Vitayaki General Secretary: Maika Namudu Asst. G/Secretary: Lepani Kolinisau Publicity Officer: Mere Nawamea Treasurer: Paula Motu Ind. Relations Officer: Joeli Kalou FTACU: Viliame S. Tunidau FTAWS: Ted Young <u>Project Education Officer:</u> Kaminieli Tagica, Rupeni Tamani, Asinate Gadolo, Aseri Tuitubou, Sivaniolo Toroca, Peceli Vitukawalu, Albert Wise, Toma Waqavono, Viliame Dileqa, Neumi Vola,	2008-2010 <u>Executive Committee</u> President - Tevita Koroi VPA - Iosefo Volau VPP - Mere Nawamea Treasurer - Josateki Malani Asst. Secretary- Miriama Namosimalua Publicity - Rusila Racule Gauna Halofaki, Fay Volatabu, Amani Namosimalua, Netani Druavesi ,Area Reps – Apisalome Vunisa, Ledua Tagilala, Emasi Ravulo, Iowane Nabulivou, Varanisese Naivalurua, Meli Tora, Seresio Druguta, Aisake Tuapati, Peni Donu, Jone Malimali, Sakiusa Duwai, Semi Vela, Tausie Fasala, Temo Tawake, Neumi Vola, Toma Waqavono.
1999 <u>Executive Committee</u> President: Susana Tuisawau VP Professional: Waisake Kedraika VP Admin: Tevita Koroi General Secretary: Maika Namudu Asst. G/Secretary: Lepani Kolinisau Public Relations Officer: Gauna Halofaki Treasurer: Paula Motu IRO Ilai Kuli Setareki Biu, Mika Rokosova, Asinate Gadolo, Tokasa Gray, Peni Delaibatiki, Amani Namosimalua	2010 <u>Executive Committee</u> President: Tevita Koroi General Secretary: Maika Namudu Principal Admin Officer: Joeli Nabuka VP (Admin/Finance): Gauna Halofaki VP (Prof.): Mere Moci Treasurer: Joji Nakaora Assistant Secretary: Miriama Namosimalua Working Committee – E. Tamanisau, Varanisese Naivalurua, Netani Cavu, Taito Draunidalo, Netani Druavesi, Lavenia Draunibaka

END